2. Creativity and Innovation Processes Steps

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Objectives

The main objective of this unit will be identifying the steps of creative and innovative processes, understanding new creative and innovation-oriented operation processes

At the end of this unit the trainees will be able to:

- Identify the steps of creative and innovative processes,
- Identify the impact of creative and innovative processes on operational effectiveness, and
- Develop problem-solving processes for creativity and innovations.

- **Creativity process steps**
- **Innovation process steps**

Creativity and innovation process steps

- The creativity and innovation process are iterative and non-linear, meaning that individuals or teams may move back and forth between stages as they refine their ideas.
- They are **critical processes** for problem-solving, product development, and organizational growth, which drive progress and allow organizations to continue competitive advantages Bellini (2024).

2.1 Creativity process steps

The Wallas model for the process of creativity widely recognized framework of creativity process steps includes the following steps: **preparation, incubation**, **illumination**, and **verification** as the process flow is illustrated in **Figure 2.1** (Sadler-Smith, 2015).

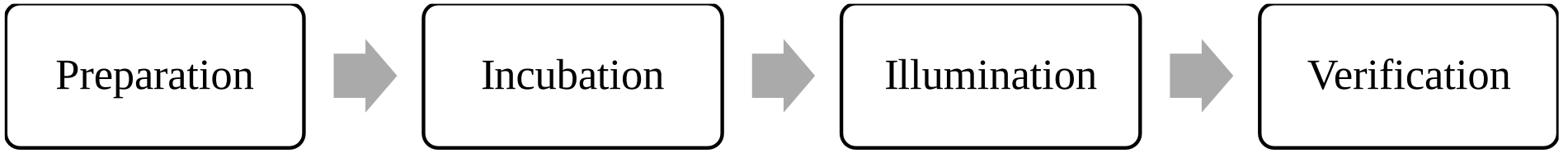


Figure 2.1 Wallis model of Creativity Process steps flow diagram

The **Wallis model** of creativity process steps is described in the following paragraphs:

- ✓ **Preparation:** This initial stage involves gathering information, understanding the problem, and exploring existing knowledge related to the challenge at hand.
- ✓ **Incubation:** It involves stepping back from the problem, and allowing the mind to wander and make connections without direct focus.
- ✓ **Illumination:** This is the "aha" moment when new ideas or solutions suddenly become clear.
- ✓ **Verification:** The ideas generated during illumination are refined, tested, and implemented.

The Barron model of creativity process emphasis on subconscious and chance processes in four- phase, and develop psychic creation model.

- The Barron's psychic creation model has four steps: **conception, gestation, parturition** and **bringing up the baby** as depicted in **Figure 2.2** (Barron, 1988).

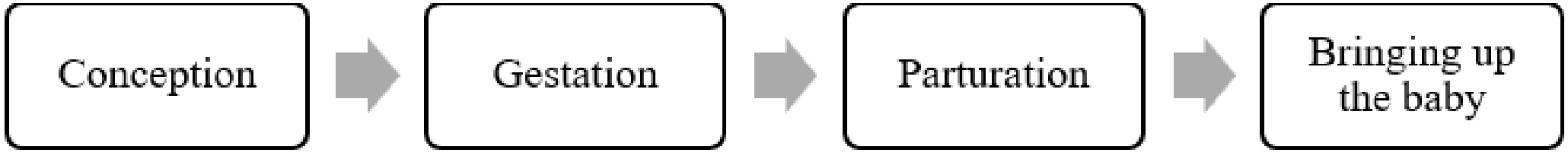


Figure 2. 2 Barron Model of Creativity Process steps flow diagram

Creative problem-solving model: It has **six steps**: **objective finding**, **fact finding, problem finding, idea finding, solution finding** and **acceptance finding** as shown in **Figure 2.3**.

- In this model, the **problem finding** and **idea finding** clearly **require novel & creative thinking**; while steps of objective finding, fact finding, solution finding and acceptance finding require traditional skills and analytical thinking.

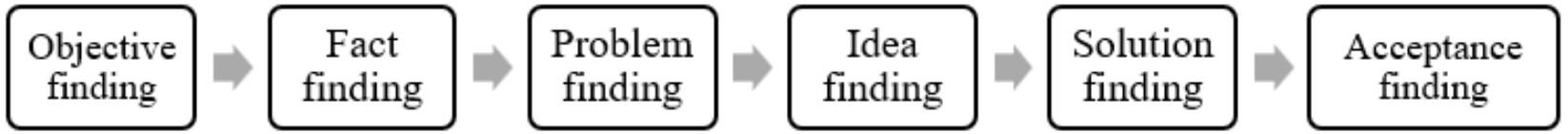


Figure 2. 3 Creative problem-solving model of creativity process steps

The **directed creativity cycle model: It** is a synthesis model of the creative process which has four steps: **Preparation, imagination, development** and **action** as depicted in **Figure 2.4.**

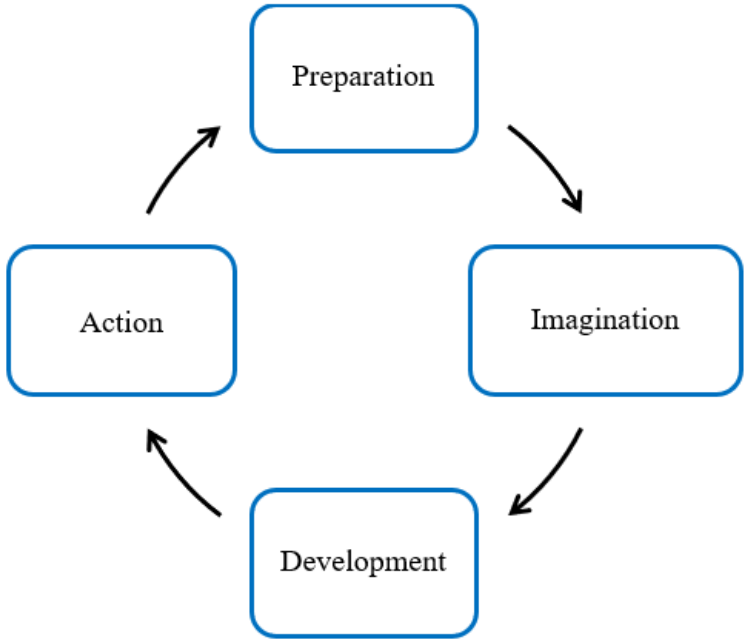


Figure 2. 4 Direct creative cycle of a synthesis model of creativity process steps

🖉 Reflective activity 2.1

1. Identify creativity process steps

2. Explain the impacts of creativity processes on operational effectiveness of organizations to enhance creativity.

2.2. Innovation process steps

- The innovation process is often described as a series of steps that guide individuals and organizations from the initial idea generation to the implementation of new products, services, or processes.
- According to the stage–gate model, the key innovation process steps are: **idea generation**, **idea screening**, **concept development** and **testing, business analysis**, **product development**, **market testing**, **commercialization** and **post-launch review** and **continuous improvement**, which are depicted in **Figure 2.5** (Tohidi & Jabbari, 2012; Anderson et al., 2014).

2.1.2. Innovation process steps

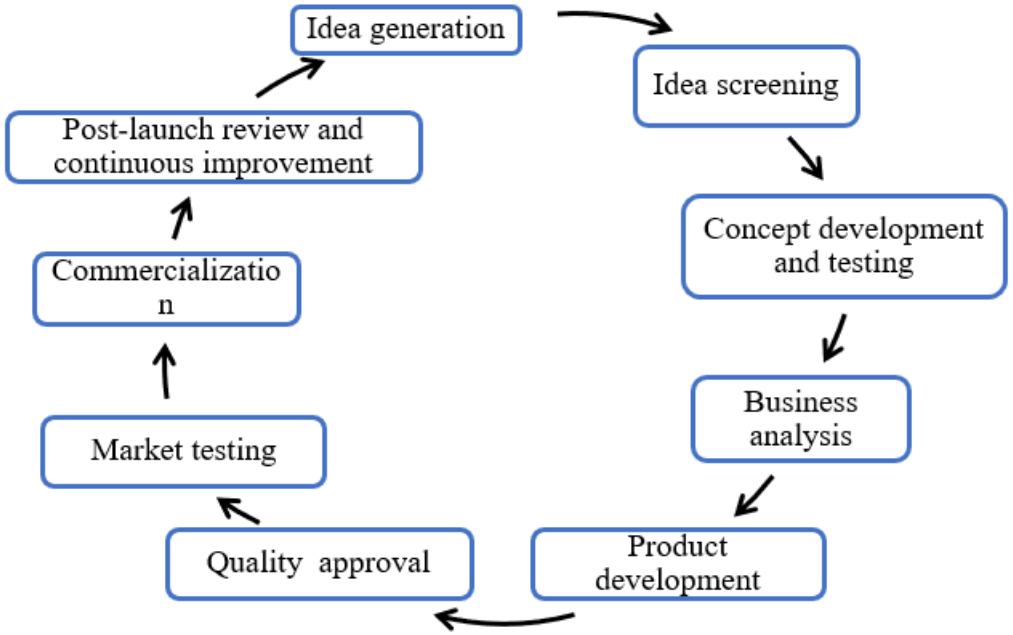


Figure 2. 5 Stage –gate model of innovation process steps

🖉 Reflective activity 2.2

1. Identify innovation process steps.

2. Describe the impacts of innovation processes on operational effectiveness of organizations to foster innovation.

Creativity and innovation processes are essential for organizations seeking to develop new ideas, products, and solutions to stay competitive and meet the evolving needs of their customers.

Creativity and innovation processes can also help to identify problems, conduct research, brainstorm, select the best ideas, create prototypes, seek feedback, and implement ideas, which embrace a continuous learning and development mindset and maintain motivation for a successful idea generation process.

Hence, growth and development of organizations cannot be sustained without additional creativity and innovation in products or services.

Thank You!